SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

AWARENESS AND KNOWLEDGE OF BASIC CONSUMER RIGHTS: AN ASSESSMENT STUDY

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Business Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
Bachelor of Science in Business Administration Major in Financial Management

By

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ABSTRACT

TITLE:	AWARENESS AND KNOWLEDGE OF BASIC CONSUMER RIGHTS: AN ASSESSMENT STUDY
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I. OBJECTIVES:

This study aims to assess the awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights as mandated under Republic Act 7394 and reinforced by DTI Policy Advisory No. 22-01.

`II. METHODOLOGY:

This study will utilize a structured survey questionnaire as its main data-gathering instrument. This tool was modified from the study of Chona Pajarillo-Agustin in her research study entitled *"Consumer Awareness Assessment Survey in the Province of Cagayan"* and further aligned with the Department of Trade and Industry's (DTI) issued guidance on the eight (8) basic consumer rights as outlined by eLegal Philippines (2022).

III. FINDINGS:

IV. RECOMMENDATIONS:

KEYWORDS: Consumer Awareness, 8 Basic Consumer Rights, Consumer Rights, RA 7394, Consumers

DEDICATION

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the Study

Consumer protection has become a global priority as markets continue to expand across physical and digital platforms. Internationally, greater emphasis has been placed on strengthening consumer protection systems to ensure fair trade practices, product safety, and accessible redress mechanisms. The United Nations Guidelines for Consumer Protection reaffirm that consumers must have access to accurate information, safe products, effective complaint channels, and education that empowers them to make informed choices (United Nations, 2022). The ASEAN Consumer Protection Framework similarly highlights the need for consistent consumer safeguards across Southeast Asia, emphasizing digital marketplace protection, cross-border trade fairness, and consumer redress mechanisms (ASEAN, 2021).

Studies by Koos (2021) and Buana Rumiartha and Indradewi (2020) illustrate that consumer protection laws should be grounded in a socially responsible market economy, where fairness is treated as an end in itself alongside efficiency. Widiarty and Fahim (2024) further emphasized the importance of strengthening institutional mechanisms to ensure effective enforcement in an increasingly globalized trade environment. Comparative analyses across nations have shown that differences in enforcement practices create inconsistent levels of consumer confidence, as discussed by Galasintu and Loveera (2021) and Dewi et al. (2024). Hlaing (2024) and Agbo-Ejeh (2023) likewise observed that as digital markets grow in complexity, consumer protection challenges multiply, requiring policy reforms that reinforce accountability and redress systems. Ahmed (2020) and Mia and Mallick (2021) established that weak enforcement mechanisms undermine compliance among producers and reduce trust in legal remedies. Comparative work by Gum (2025) in South Sudan and Tshiki (2025) in South Africa further

indicated that living conditions, education, and government efficiency significantly influence how protection frameworks are utilized by citizens.

Within the Southeast Asian context, scholars have discussed both the evolution and limitations of consumer protection. Koos (2021) examined consistency in designing socially responsible consumer legislation, while Arellano-Asas (2024) reviewed challenges in implementing the Philippine Consumer Act. Galasintu and Loveera (2021) compared ASEAN legal frameworks and identified gaps in harmonization and enforcement capacity. At the national level, studies have explored consumer understanding of laws and enforcement practices. Baquiran et al. (2024) investigated students' awareness of Republic Act No. 7394 and found significant knowledge gaps even among educated groups. Alonzo and Caurel (2023) reported that consumers in Northern Philippines often rely on informal dispute resolution, reflecting low engagement with formal legal mechanisms. Pajarillo-Agustin (2023) similarly found that while awareness campaigns in Cagayan Province improved understanding of consumer rights, they did not lead to a substantial increase in formal complaints.

In the Philippine context, consumer welfare is primarily protected through Republic Act No. 7394, also known as the Consumer Act of the Philippines. This law establishes standards for product quality, fair trade practices, consumer redress, and education. To strengthen public understanding, the Department of Trade and Industry issued Policy Advisory No. 22-01 in May 2022, clarifying the Eight Basic Consumer Rights: The Right to Basic Needs, Safety, Information, Choice, Representation, Redress, Consumer Education, and a Healthy Environment (DTI, 2022).

Disini and Disini Law Office (2022) explained that these rights are fundamental protections guaranteed by the Constitution and various laws to ensure consumer welfare. The Right to Basic Needs ensures access to essential goods and services such as food, clothing, shelter, health care,

education, utilities, water, and sanitation, supported by the 1987 Constitution, the Price Act (RA 7581), and the Local Government Code (RA 7160). The Right to Safety protects consumers from hazardous products and services through the Consumer Act (RA 7394), the Food Safety Act (RA 10611), and provisions of the Local Government Code. The Right to Information guarantees access to truthful facts for informed decision-making and protection against deceptive advertising through RA 7394 and the No Shortchanging Act (RA 10909). The Right to Choose allows consumers to select from a range of quality products and services at competitive prices, as supported by the Philippine Competition Act (RA 10667). The Right to Representation ensures that consumer interests are considered in policymaking, as provided under RA 7394 and RA 7581. The Right to Redress grants consumers fair settlement of claims and compensation for defective or misrepresented goods and services, protected by RA 7394 and RA 8293. The Right to Consumer Education empowers individuals through knowledge and skills for informed choices, reinforced by RA 7394, RA 3720, and RA 9211. The Right to a Healthy Environment guarantees a safe and sustainable environment for present and future generations, enshrined in the 1987 Constitution, RA 7394, and RA 9003. Disini and Disini Law Office (2022) further emphasized that these rights are not exclusive and may be supported by other statutes and regulations.

Melad et al. (2023) observed that although consumers generally express satisfaction with available protection mechanisms, many remain unfamiliar with the legal remedies under RA 7394. Studies by Devi and Kalita (2020) and Nathiya and Kasthuri (2021) showed that awareness of consumer rights often depends on education level, income, and location. These findings collectively demonstrate that despite strong national laws, local enforcement and awareness in the Philippines remain uneven. Few scholarly works in the Caraga Region, particularly in Agusan del Norte, have assessed the implementation of RA 7394 and the extent to which consumers

actively exercise their rights. While the Department of Trade and Industry Caraga and ConsumerNet initiatives report ongoing information drives, no academic study has systematically measured their impact at the provincial level. Understanding these elements will help evaluate the effectiveness of RA 7394 and guide policy recommendations aimed at strengthening consumer confidence and enforcement strategies in the region.

Despite the increasing number of studies on consumer protection and awareness of consumer rights in different regions of the Philippines, a review of the available academic studies shows that there is no empirical study that has been conducted in the Caraga Region, specifically in Agusan del Norte, to determine the level of awareness and practice of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights among consumers. The studies undertaken so far are focused on other provinces and other sectors of society, thus there is a need for an empirical study to determine the level of awareness and practice of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights among consumers in Agusan del Norte.

The purpose of this study is to evaluate how well consumers understand and exercise their legally protected rights. It aims to determine the level of awareness regarding the Eight Basic Consumer Rights and to assess how effectively government policies, laws, and consumer education programs have reached the public. The study also seeks to examine whether consumers can assert these rights when faced with unfair trade practices, unsafe products, or misleading information. The research addresses a gap in empirical evidence measuring consumer awareness across different demographics in the Philippines. While legal frameworks are well established, limited attention has been given to whether consumers are empowered to use these rights in practice. By addressing this gap, the study provides evidence-based insights into strengths and weaknesses in consumer awareness and identifies areas where education, advocacy, and enforcement must be improved.

The significance of this study extends to multiple stakeholders. For consumers, the findings may encourage greater proactiveness in asserting their rights. For the Department of Trade and Industry and Local Government Units, the results may serve as a basis for designing more focused consumer awareness and advocacy programs in Agusan del Norte. Business establishments may gain insights that encourage compliance with RA 7394 and promote ethical trade practices. The College of Business and Management may also use the findings for curricular enhancement, module development, and integration of consumer protection concepts into business courses, strengthening both instruction and research in the field.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

This chapter reviews related literature on consumers and consumer rights awareness, with emphasis on the factors influencing awareness of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights. Several studies conducted in the Philippines have examined consumer awareness, knowledge, and practices related to consumer rights and protection, although none focus specifically on the province of Agusan del Norte. The review is organized based on the study's conceptual framework, beginning with the main concept of consumers and consumer protection, followed by the sub-variables of access to consumer information and the Eight Basic Consumer Rights. The discussion then proceeds to consumer profiling variables, which are examined as factors that may influence variations in consumer rights awareness. Local, national, and international studies are synthesized to establish the theoretical and empirical basis of the study.

Consumer rights awareness refers to consumers' knowledge and understanding of their legal entitlements and responsibilities in market transactions. Awareness enables consumers to make informed purchasing decisions, recognize unsafe or deceptive practices, and seek remedies when violations occur. According to the OECD (2023), informed consumers contribute to safer

markets and improved regulatory outcomes by actively participating in complaint and feedback mechanisms.

International studies suggest that consumers with higher awareness levels are less vulnerable to exploitation and more confident in engaging with sellers and regulatory agencies (Agbo-Ejeh, 2023). Conversely, consumers with limited awareness tend to tolerate unfair practices or refrain from filing complaints due to lack of knowledge or trust in institutions. In the Philippines, Arellano-Asas (2024) observed that many consumers remain passive despite experiencing violations, largely because they are unaware of complaint procedures and responsible agencies.

The literature also emphasizes that consumers are not a homogeneous group. Their awareness and engagement in consumer protection vary depending on access to information, institutional support, and individual characteristics. This variation supports the need to examine specific factors that influence how consumers learn about and exercise their rights.

Access to consumer information is a key determinant of consumer rights awareness. Information allows consumers to evaluate product safety, quality, price fairness, and seller credibility. The OECD (2023) emphasizes that reliable and accessible information strengthens consumer confidence and promotes responsible consumption, particularly in markets characterized by rapid technological change.

Studies show that consumers obtain information from multiple sources, including printed materials, institutional and community-based programs, mass media, and digital platforms. However, access to these sources remains uneven, especially in rural and low-connectivity areas (ITU, 2024). In the Philippine setting, disparities in information access have been linked to differences in consumer awareness and participation in redress mechanisms (Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023; Melad et al., 2023).

Exposure to Mass Media

Mass media, including television, radio, newspapers, and social media, plays a significant role in shaping consumer awareness. The International Telecommunication Union (ITU, 2024) identifies mass media as a principal channel for disseminating consumer protection information, particularly in developing regions where institutional outreach is limited. Similarly, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD, 2023) reports that consumers who are regularly exposed to mass media demonstrate higher awareness of consumer risks, legal rights, and available redress mechanisms.

In the Philippine context, empirical studies support the influence of mass media on consumer rights awareness. Baquiran et al. (2024) found that students who regularly engage with media-based advisories, including television programs and social media campaigns, exhibit greater knowledge of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights under Republic Act No. 7394. Local provincial surveys conducted in Cagayan and Quirino further reveal that communities reached by Department of Trade and Industry (DTI) announcements through television and radio have higher levels of awareness compared to communities with limited media access (Melad et al., 2023; Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023).

Exposure to mass media is especially critical in rapidly changing markets where product risks, misleading advertisements, and fraudulent practices are increasingly prevalent. Through timely and wide-reaching dissemination of information, mass media enables consumers to recognize unsafe products, understand their legal protections, and identify appropriate channels for redress. Collectively, the literature establishes mass media exposure as a strong predictor of

consumer rights literacy, as it provides accessible and credible information that supports informed decision-making across diverse consumer groups.

Exposure to Printed Materials

Exposure to printed materials such as brochures, posters, flyers, manuals, and product labels plays an important role in enhancing awareness of consumer rights. Printed information remains essential for consumers in rural and low-connectivity areas who may not have regular access to digital platforms or mass media. Dewi et al. (2024) emphasize that printed materials are particularly effective in Asian contexts, where information dissemination often occurs through physical distribution within communities.

In the Philippine setting, Javier et al. (2024) found that exposure to printed materials, especially through reading product labels, is associated with higher levels of safety awareness. Studies conducted by Pajarillo-Agustin (2023) and Melad et al. (2023) further reported that printed DTI posters and announcements visibly improved consumer knowledge, particularly in rural areas.

Printed materials therefore play a critical role in bridging information gaps. Philippine evidence highlights their continued relevance, as Filipinos who frequently read printed advisories demonstrate a stronger understanding of product standards and safety information, directly supporting the Right to Safety and the Right to Information (Javier et al., 2024). Surveys conducted in Quirino and Cagayan provinces showed that printed DTI posters placed in stores and public spaces increased consumers' familiarity with rights such as redress and representation, even among individuals with limited media exposure (Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023; Melad et al., 2023). Because printed materials are tangible, simple, and easily accessible, they remain one of the most reliable tools for promoting consumer literacy, particularly among seniors, persons with disabilities (PWDs), and rural communities that rely heavily on non-digital communication.

Exposure to Institutional and Community Sources

Institutional and community-based sources such as DTI seminars, barangay orientations, and school-based campaigns significantly enhance consumer rights awareness. The Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD, 2023) emphasizes that information provided by formal institutions is generally more credible and impactful than commercial or unregulated sources.

In the Philippine context, Baquiran et al. (2024) found that institutional learning substantially improves awareness of Republic Act No. 7394. Community-based surveys conducted in Cagayan and Quirino provinces further confirmed that participation in barangay orientations and LGU-led programs strengthened understanding of the Right to Redress and the Right to Representation (Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023; Melad et al., 2023). Institutional exposure therefore contributes to higher levels of consumer confidence and legal knowledge.

Institutional and community-based information sources also play a central role in building long-term consumer literacy. OECD (2023) asserts that such sources are often perceived as unbiased and authoritative, while the International Telecommunication Union (ITU, 2024) stresses that governments and consumer organizations must remain key actors in educating citizens about marketplace risks. Philippine studies strongly support this view, as Baquiran et al. (2024) reported that students who received consumer education through schools or government-led workshops exhibited significantly higher awareness of their rights under RA 7394. Community surveys in Quirino and Cagayan also showed that barangay-led and LGU-supported campaigns increased awareness of the Right to Redress, Right to Representation, and Right to Consumer Education

(Melad et al., 2023; Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023). Because institutional channels provide structured, accurate, and targeted information, they are vital in addressing awareness gaps, particularly in remote areas with limited mass media penetration.

Right to Basic Needs

The Right to Basic Needs ensures consumers' access to essential goods and services at reasonable prices. The United Nations Guidelines for Consumer Protection identify equitable access to basic necessities as the foundation of consumer protection systems worldwide (United Nations, 2022). In the Philippine context, Republic Act No. 7394 and DTI Policy Advisory No. 22-01 explicitly affirm this right, mandating government agencies to ensure the availability and affordability of essential goods (DTI, 2022).

Despite these legal protections, studies conducted in rural provinces reveal that many Filipino consumers remain unaware of their entitlement to price stability and quality standards, leaving them vulnerable to exploitation (Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023). Arellano-Asas (2024) similarly noted that while the legal framework supports the Right to Basic Needs, its implementation varies across regions. International literature further indicates that inconsistent regulatory enforcement disproportionately affects vulnerable groups, such as low-income households and senior citizens (Mia & Mallick, 2021). Overall, awareness of the Right to Basic Needs is crucial for protecting consumer welfare and promoting equitable access to essential goods and services.

Right to Safety

The Right to Safety requires that consumers be protected from hazardous products and services. In the Philippines, this right is legally anchored in Republic Act No. 7394 and reinforced by the Food Safety Act of 2013 (Republic Act No. 10611), which mandates proper labeling, safe processing, and the removal of harmful products from the market. International organizations

such as the OECD (2023) emphasize that safety standards are essential in protecting consumers, particularly in markets characterized by rapid product turnover.

Local studies indicate that despite existing legal protections, consumer awareness of safety provisions remains uneven. Labana et al. (2024) found that many consumers in Manila lacked consistent knowledge of food safety standards, leading to risky consumption behaviors. Comparative Asian research by Dewi et al. (2024) also highlighted inconsistencies in safety enforcement across countries, including the Philippines. These findings demonstrate that although safety regulations exist, limited awareness undermines their effectiveness. Strengthening awareness of the Right to Safety is therefore essential to prevent harm and promote informed, health-conscious consumer behavior.

Right to Information

The Right to Information ensures that consumers receive accurate, truthful, and complete details needed to make informed purchasing decisions. This right covers proper product labeling, transparent advertising, and full disclosure of essential product characteristics. In the Philippines, the Consumer Act of the Philippines (RA 7394) mandates truthful product representation and prohibits misleading or deceptive advertising. Empirical evidence shows that consumer literacy strongly influences the exercise of this right. Javier et al. (2024) found that consumers with higher educational attainment are more likely to read and understand product labels, while Baquiran et al. (2024) reported that students exposed to consumer education programs demonstrated better awareness of misleading claims and labeling requirements.

Local studies further highlight the role of information access. Research conducted in Cagayan and Quirino provinces revealed that printed advisories and consumer seminars improved awareness of information rights, although gaps persisted in remote communities with limited

access to reliable sources (Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023; Melad et al., 2023). At the international level, the International Telecommunication Union and the OECD have warned that the rise of digital misinformation and deceptive online marketing has heightened risks for consumers, making information rights increasingly critical (ITU, 2024; OECD, 2023). Protecting the Right to Information empowers consumers to evaluate product quality, avoid hazards, and make rational market choices.

Right to Choose

The Right to Choose guarantees consumers access to a variety of goods and services offered at competitive prices and acceptable quality. In the Philippine context, this right is protected under RA 7394 and reinforced by the Philippine Competition Act (RA 10667), which aims to prevent monopolistic and anti-competitive practices. Comparative studies in ASEAN countries demonstrate that strong competition laws contribute to improved product availability and quality (Galasintu & Loveera, 2021). Global consumer research further indicates that choice plays a significant role in consumer satisfaction and trust (McKinsey, 2025).

Despite these protections, awareness of the Right to Choose remains uneven. Arellano-Asas (2024) found that many consumers in Philippine provinces have limited understanding of competitive market rights, restricting their ability to recognize unfair practices. Demographic factors also influence the exercise of this right, as younger and more educated consumers tend to compare products more effectively and make informed decisions (Lim, 2024; Nathiya & Kasthuri, 2021). Ensuring awareness of the Right to Choose is therefore essential for protecting consumers from market abuse and promoting fair competition.

Right to Representation

The Right to Representation ensures that consumer interests are considered in policymaking and regulatory processes. In the Philippines, this right is institutionalized through mechanisms identified in DTI Policy Advisory No. 22-01, which emphasizes consumer participation in promoting welfare and market fairness (DTI, 2022). Representation structures such as ConsumerNet and Local Price Coordinating Councils are designed to facilitate communication between consumers and regulatory agencies (DTI, 2023).

However, local studies reveal that awareness and participation in these mechanisms remain limited. Surveys conducted in Cagayan and Quirino provinces showed that many consumers were unfamiliar with formal representation channels, reducing their capacity to influence policy or report systemic concerns (Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023; Melad et al., 2023). International research supports these findings, indicating that strong representation enhances transparency, accountability, and regulatory responsiveness (Koos, 2021). Strengthening the Right to Representation is therefore vital for empowering consumers and improving institutional trust.

Right to Redress

The Right to Redress allows consumers to seek remedies such as refunds, replacements, or repairs for defective, unfairly priced, or falsely advertised products. Under RA 7394, the Department of Trade and Industry is mandated to enforce these protections and ensure accessible complaint mechanisms. Despite the existence of a legal framework, studies show that awareness and utilization of redress systems remain low. Regional research in Quirino and Cagayan provinces found that consumers rarely file complaints due to limited awareness, weak institutional access, and lack of trust in enforcement processes (Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023; Melad et al., 2023).

National and international evidence supports these observations. Arellano-Asas (2024) reported that many Filipino consumers are unfamiliar with complaint procedures, while international studies highlight that perceived inefficiency and distrust often discourage consumers from exercising redress rights (Agbo-Ejeh, 2023). These findings underscore the importance of awareness campaigns and institutional support in strengthening consumers' confidence and ability to assert their right to redress.

Right to Consumer Education

The Right to Consumer Education ensures that individuals acquire the knowledge and skills necessary to make informed decisions in the marketplace. In the Philippines, the DTI mandates educational initiatives aimed at strengthening consumer awareness (DTI, 2022). Consumer education has been shown to improve individuals' ability to identify deceptive practices and understand product information (Selvi & Anusuya, 2021). Local studies demonstrate that school- and community-based programs significantly enhance awareness of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights (Baquiran et al., 2024).

However, access to consumer education remains uneven. Surveys in provincial areas reveal gaps in program availability, particularly in rural communities (Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023; Melad et al., 2023). International organizations stress that as markets become increasingly digital, consumer education must also address online fraud, data privacy, and misleading digital advertising (OECD, 2023). Strengthening consumer education is therefore essential for empowering individuals to protect their rights in both traditional and digital marketplaces.

Right to a Healthy Environment

The Right to a Healthy Environment protects consumers from goods and practices that harm environmental and public health. In the Philippines, RA 7394 links consumer welfare with

environmental protection, while sustainability is further reinforced through DTI policies and environmental legislation such as the Ecological Solid Waste Management Act (RA 9003). International studies show growing consumer interest in environmentally friendly products, although transparency in environmental claims remains a concern (Mbokane et al., 2024).

Despite increasing environmental awareness, local studies indicate that knowledge of environmental consumer rights remains limited, particularly in rural areas (Arellano-Asas, 2024). Global consumer trend reports further note that while consumers increasingly prefer sustainable products, clearer labeling and stronger institutional support are needed to guide environmentally responsible choices (McKinsey, 2025). Strengthening the Right to a Healthy Environment is essential, as environmental risks such as pollution and toxic products directly affect consumer health and long-term well-being.

Age

Age is widely recognized as a key determinant of consumer awareness and legal literacy, influencing how individuals process product information, perceive risks, and engage in consumer protection behaviors. Younger consumers are generally more exposed to digital platforms and online campaigns, giving them greater access to updated consumer information and safety advisories (Nathiya & Kasthuri, 2021). In contrast, older consumers often rely on traditional media, community discussions, and experience-based judgment, which may limit their exposure to current consumer regulations and digital complaint mechanisms (Kainyu, 2023).

Philippine studies confirm that age significantly predicts product label reading and comprehension. Javier et al. (2024) found that younger consumers show more consistent engagement in evaluating product information. Regional surveys further reveal that older age groups, particularly in rural areas, tend to have lower awareness of the Eight Basic Consumer

Rights and are less likely to file consumer complaints (Pajarillo-Agustin, 2023). Because awareness of rights such as the Right to Safety and the Right to Information depends on timely and accurate information processing, age remains a meaningful variable in understanding disparities in consumer protection knowledge.

Supporting international evidence shows similar patterns. Rawal (2021) observed that college students are increasingly aware of consumer issues but lack deeper understanding of legal remedies. Kainyu (2023) reported that older consumers in Nairobi possess experiential knowledge but limited formal awareness of consumer protection laws. Nathiya and Kasthuri (2021) found that middle-aged consumers tend to demonstrate balanced awareness due to their economic and household decision-making responsibilities. In the Philippine context, Pajarillo-Agustin (2023) noted that younger consumers in Cagayan were generally aware of product safety but unfamiliar with formal complaint and redress mechanisms. Likewise, Valvi et al. (2025) observed that younger consumers showed strong brand awareness but insufficient knowledge of legal protections. Taken together, these findings establish age as a critical demographic factor influencing consumer awareness, information-seeking behavior, and engagement with redress systems.

Educational Attainment

Educational attainment consistently emerges as one of the strongest predictors of consumer awareness, comprehension of product information, and understanding of legal remedies. Baquiran et al. (2024) reported that students from ISU–Cauayan City Campus demonstrated moderate awareness of RA 7394 but had limited understanding of its implementation mechanisms. Similarly, Devi and Kalita (2020) found that restricted educational opportunities among rural women in Assam contributed to poor awareness of consumer rights.

International studies reinforce the importance of education. Mohammed Ashraf and Franklin (2025) identified educational attainment as a significant predictor of consumer participation in complaint and advocacy processes, while Selvi and Anusuya (2021) concluded that classroom-based consumer education strengthens both awareness and confidence in exercising legal rights. Local evidence supports these findings, as Alonzo and Caurel (2023) observed that educated consumers in Northern Philippines were more likely to question unfair business practices.

Further research shows that education enhances consumers' ability to interpret labels, understand safety warnings, and identify misleading advertisements (Osei, 2024). In the Philippine setting, Javier et al. (2024) confirmed that individuals with higher education levels are more capable of reading and evaluating product labels, directly supporting the Right to Information and the Right to Safety. Conversely, Pajarillo-Agustin (2023) found that consumers with lower educational attainment were less aware of their rights under RA 7394 and less likely to engage in redress processes. Since the Eight Basic Consumer Rights require not only awareness but also comprehension and application, educational attainment plays a direct and critical role in enabling consumers to protect themselves effectively.

Sex

Sex differences also influence consumer awareness and engagement in consumer protection activities. Some international studies indicate that women in economically marginalized communities exhibit lower awareness of consumer rights due to limited access to education and institutional resources (Tshiki, 2025; Devi & Kalita, 2020). However, other findings suggest that educated women tend to be more cautious and rights-conscious buyers than men (Nathiya & Kasthuri, 2021).

Research further shows that women are generally more attentive to product safety, nutritional labels, and consumer advisories, particularly for household and food-related goods. Their active role in household purchasing decisions may explain their greater vigilance in verifying product information (Kainyu, 2023). In the Philippine context, Javier et al. (2024) found that female consumers were more likely to read and understand labels and express stronger interest in safety-related information. However, Melad et al. (2023) reported minimal sex differences in consumer awareness in Quirino province, suggesting increasing parity due to improved education and advocacy efforts. Man Mohan et al. (2025) similarly noted heightened interest among women following exposure to consumer rights campaigns. These findings highlight the importance of including sex as a demographic variable, as it affects awareness depth, safety vigilance, and participation in consumer education initiatives.

Customer Category (PWD, Senior, Able-Bodied)

Customer category significantly affects consumers' access to information and understanding of their rights. Vulnerable groups such as seniors and persons with disabilities (PWDs) often face barriers related to mobility, accessibility, and information availability, limiting their participation in consumer education programs (Kainyu, 2023). International research indicates that these groups have lower exposure to consumer protection messaging and encounter difficulties navigating digital platforms where most advisories are disseminated (Osei, 2024).

Philippine studies support these observations. Pajarillo-Agustin (2023) found that seniors and rural consumers have limited familiarity with consumer rights and complaint procedures due to physical constraints and restricted access to institutions such as DTI offices. Nathiya and Kasthuri (2021) also noted that socio-economically vulnerable groups often rely on informal information networks, increasing the risk of misinformation and safety violations. Since PWDs and senior

citizens are identified as priority sectors in government programs, examining their level of consumer rights awareness is essential in assessing whether legal protections and information systems are inclusive and equitable.

The literature demonstrates that consumer awareness is strongly influenced by access to information through mass media, printed materials, and institutional or community-based sources. Although RA 7394 provides a comprehensive legal framework, awareness of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights remains uneven, particularly in rural areas and among vulnerable populations. Demographic factors such as age, educational attainment, sex, and customer category significantly shape consumers' understanding and exercise of their rights. Younger and more educated consumers generally exhibit higher awareness, while older adults, individuals with lower education levels, and PWDs face greater informational and accessibility barriers.

These findings justify the inclusion of demographic characteristics and information exposure as key variables in examining awareness of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights. The present study seeks to assess these relationships at the local level to generate evidence-based recommendations for strengthening consumer literacy and effective rights protection within the community.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study is anchored on the *Consumer Empowerment Theory* and the *Information Integration Theory*, which explain how awareness and access to information influence consumer decision-making.

Consumer Empowerment Theory (CET)

Consumer Empowerment Theory explains that consumers become empowered when they possess adequate knowledge, awareness of their rights, and the confidence to exercise these

rights in the marketplace. Empowered consumers are more capable of evaluating product quality, identifying unfair trade practices, and seeking appropriate redress when violations occur. Studies applying CET emphasize that consumer knowledge and legal awareness are central to empowerment and effective participation in market transactions (Koos, 2021; Buana Rumiartha & Indradewi, 2020).

In the Philippine context, awareness of Republic Act No. 7394, or the Consumer Act of the Philippines, is a critical element of consumer empowerment. Guided by CET, the present study assumes that consumers who are knowledgeable about the Eight Basic Consumer Rights are more empowered and better equipped to protect themselves against unsafe products, misleading information, and unfair business practices.

Consumer Information Processing Theory

Consumer Information Processing Theory explains how consumers perceive, interpret, store, and use information when making decisions. According to Darke and Dahl (2020), consumers' judgments and awareness are influenced not only by the availability of information but also by how clearly and frequently the information is communicated. The theory emphasizes that repeated exposure to reliable and understandable information enhances consumer comprehension and recall.

In the context of this study, CIPT explains how consumers process information obtained from media advisories, institutional campaigns, and printed materials related to consumer rights. Consumers who are repeatedly exposed to clear consumer protection messages are more likely to understand the provisions of RA 7394 and apply their rights in real-life market situations. This theory therefore strengthens the assumption that access to information directly contributes to higher levels of consumer rights awareness and knowledge.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

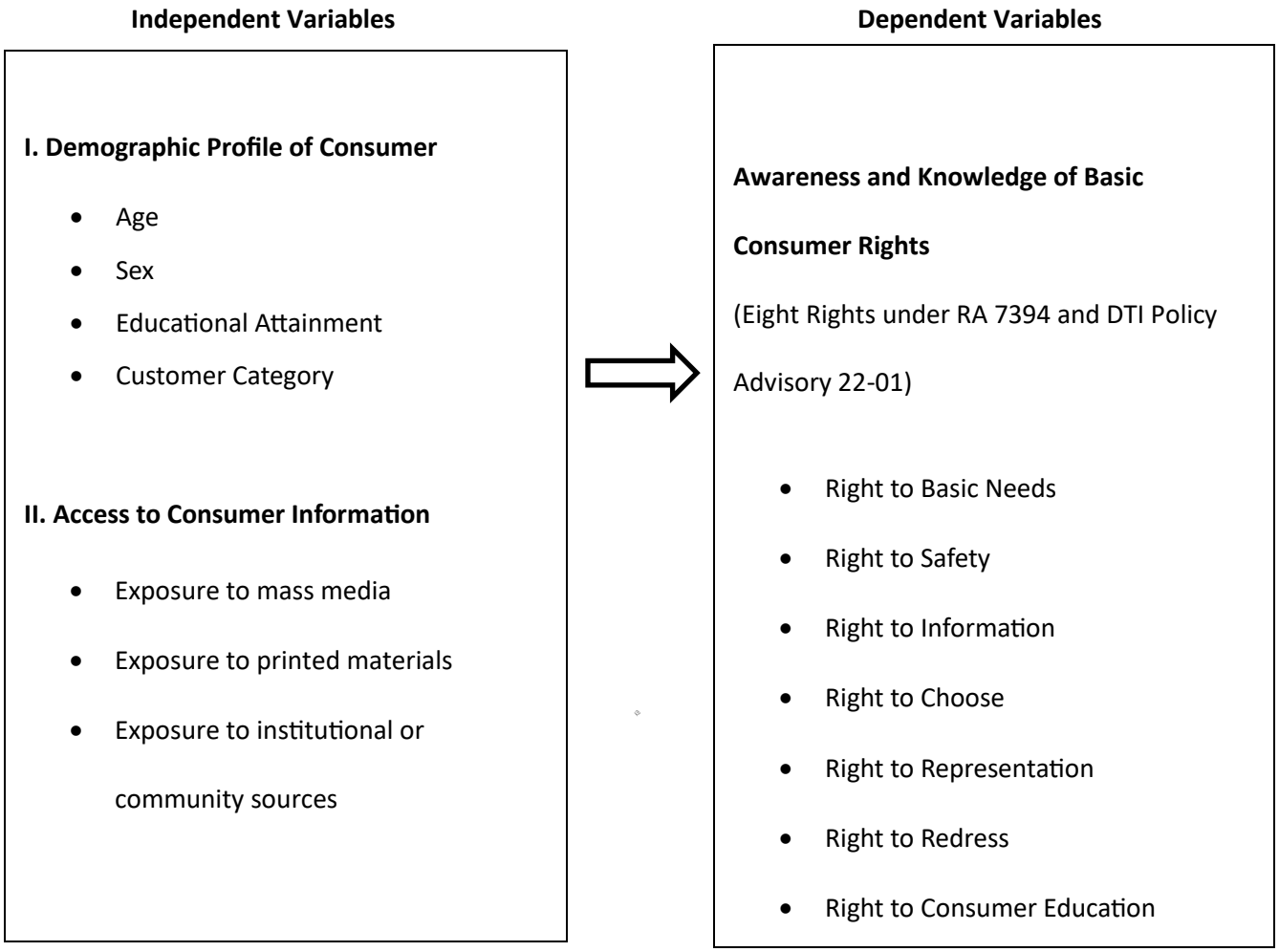


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the interplay between the independent and dependent variables of the study.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

This study aims to assess the awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights as mandated under Republic Act 7394 and reinforced by DTI Policy Advisory No. 22-01. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of:

    1.1 Age;

1.2 Gender;

1.3 Educational Attainment; and

1.4 Customer Category?

2. What is the level of access to consumer information of the respondents in terms of:

2.1 Exposure to mass media;

2.2 Exposure to printed information materials; and

2.3 Exposure to community or institutional information sources?

3. What is the level of awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights in terms of:

3.1 Right to Basic Needs;

3.2 Right to Safety;

3.3 Right to Information;

3.4 Right to Choose;

3.5 Right to Representation;

3.6 Right to Redress;

3.7 Right to Consumer Education; and

3.8 Right to a Healthy Environment?

4. Is there a significant relationship between the demographic profile of respondents and their level of awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights?

5. Is there a significant relationship between access to consumer information and the level of awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights?

Hypothesis

Null Hypothesis

H_{01}: There is no significant relationship between the demographic profile of respondents and their level of awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights.

H_{02}: There is no significant relationship between the access to consumer information and the level of awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights.

1.6 Scope and Limitations

This study focuses on three municipalities of Agusan del Norte—Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen—representing both urban and rural communities. These locales were chosen to capture diverse consumer experiences and variations in access to information, retail services, and institutional support. Urban areas typically provide greater exposure to consumer information, while rural areas may face challenges such as limited media access and fewer outreach programs.

The study population comprises adult consumers aged 18 years and above who actively purchase goods and services from retail stores, including supermarkets, grocery stores, and convenience stores. These respondents were chosen because they directly engage with the marketplace and therefore have the opportunity to exercise their consumer rights. Simple random sampling was employed to select participants while ensuring that key characteristics—age, sex, and educational attainment—are represented. This approach ensures that respondents have sufficient exposure, experience, and understanding to provide meaningful insights into the awareness and application of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights under RA 7394.

Overall, these municipalities and respondents were chosen to reflect a realistic and diverse picture of consumer behavior in Agusan del Norte, allowing the study to generate locally relevant data that can inform consumer education, policy interventions, and future research.

1.7 Definition of Terms

The terms are operationally defined based on their use in this study.

8 Basic Consumer Rights. Refers to the respondents' awareness and understanding of the eight fundamental consumer rights as measured by their answers to survey items in the study.

Age. Used to categorize consumers into generational groups to determine whether awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights vary across age brackets.

Consumer Rights Awareness. Defined as the extent to which consumers in Agusan del Norte are informed about their basic consumer rights and responsibilities, as measured through the data-gathering tools used in this study.

Consumer Rights. Refers to the specific entitlements guaranteed to consumers under RA 7394, including the right to safety, information, choice, and redress as understood and exercised by respondents in Agusan del Norte.

Educational Attainment. Refers to the level of formal education completed by the respondent, which is used to analyze whether consumer awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights are influenced by educational background.

Exposure to Mass Media. This refers to the extent to which respondents access information through mass communication channels such as television, radio, and online news platforms. In this study, it is measured by the respondents' self-reported frequency and duration of using these media sources.

Exposure to Printed Materials. This refers to the degree to which respondents engage with printed informational resources, including newspapers, magazines, brochures, flyers, or books. In this study, it is measured by how often and how long respondents read or use such materials.

Exposure to Institutional or Community Sources. This refers to the level of contact respondents have with information disseminated through formal institutions and community organizations, such as schools, health centers, government offices, religious groups, or local community programs.

Gender. Refers to the biological classification of respondents, used to explore potential differences in consumer awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights between sexes.

RA 7394 (Consumer Act of the Philippines). The term RA 7394 also known as the Consumer Act of the Philippines is defined as the primary legal framework assessed in this study, focusing on its enforcement in Agusan del Norte.

Respondents. Refer to the individuals who are selected to participate in a study and who provide data by answering the research questionnaire or survey instruments during the data-gathering process.

Right to Basic Needs. Refers to level to which consumers in Agusan del Norte can obtain basic goods and services at fair prices and satisfactory quality, measured by their knowledge and perception of access to such necessities.

Right to Safety. It relates to consumer's level of awareness of their protection from unsafe or defective products, and their confidence that businesses and government agencies enforce safety standards under RA 7394.

Right to Information. Define as a respondents' awareness of their right to honest and complete information about goods and services, such as clear labeling, advertising, and product content.

Right to Choose. The right to choose from variety of products and services at competitive prices.

Right to Representation. The right for consumer interests to be heard and represented in the making of government policies.

Right to Redress. The right to be compensated for mis presentation, poor quality goods, or unsatisfactory services.

Right to Consumer Education. The right to acquire to knowledge and skills needed to be informed consumer

Right to a Healthy Environment. The right to live and work in an environment that is safe and allows for formal life.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents the research methods and procedures used in conducting the study. It describes the research design, respondents of the study, research instruments, data-gathering procedures, and data analysis techniques employed to ensure the validity and reliability of the findings.

2.1 Research Design

This study employs a descriptive-quantitative research design to examine consumer awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights in Agusan del Norte. This method focuses on gathering numerical data through a structured questionnaire to measure consumers' level of awareness and their understanding of fundamental consumer rights. Using statistical tools, the study aims to identify relationships between key variables such as age, gender, education level, and the respondents' awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights. This approach allows for an objective analysis of the current situation without altering existing conditions, providing a clear and measurable understanding of consumer rights awareness in the study area.

This research design is appropriate because the study aims to describe the current level of consumer awareness and knowledge using measurable data and analyzing patterns and relationships among variables. The descriptive-quantitative research approach is appropriate because it enables a comparison to be made, generalization of results, and statistical analysis of the responses of the consumers.

2.2 Research Locale

The study was conducted in Agusan del Norte, a province in the Caraga Region of Mindanao, Philippines. The study area is limited to the municipalities of Buenavista, Nasipit, and

Carmen, which were purposively selected to represent the urban, commercial, and rural settings of the province.

Buenavista is a first-class municipality situated in the western side of Agusan del Norte. It is a growing trade and service center in the province. According to the 2024 Census of Population, Buenavista has an estimated population of 70,691 people. This makes it one of the most populated municipalities in the province. It has 25 barangays with a combination of urbanizing and agricultural areas. This provides valuable information on consumer awareness in semi-urban areas.

Nasipit is a coastal municipality famous for its port and trading activities, thus creating an interesting environment for studying consumer engagement in very transactional settings. As of 2024, Nasipit has a population of approximately 46,000 people, and it is divided into 19 barangays. The existence of trading centers and transportation hubs makes Nasipit an important location for studying consumer knowledge in more urbanized settings.

Carmen is mainly a rural area with semi-urban parts, and it is situated along the western corridor of the province. It has a projected population of 23,304 as of 2024, with a total of 8 barangays. Agricultural and natural resource-based sectors are the main sources of livelihood for the people, making Carmen a very important location for studying consumer awareness in terms of access to formal information and services, which may vary from other urban municipalities.

The representation of these three municipalities ensures that the results of the study are applicable to the different economic, geographic, and social settings of Agusan del Norte regarding consumer awareness and access to information on consumer rights.

2.3 Research Respondents

This study employed stratified random sampling with proportional allocation as the primary sampling technique. Stratified sampling was deemed appropriate because the population of registered consumers in Agusan del Norte is not homogeneous and can be meaningfully divided into subgroups (strata) based on municipality and sex. By stratifying the population, the study ensured that key demographic characteristics were adequately represented in the sample, thereby reducing sampling bias and increasing the precision of the results.

The respondents of this study will be registered consumers residing in Agusan del Norte, Philippines. A registered consumer is defined as an individual who is officially recognized or documented as a consumer, typically through participation in formal market transactions or registration with relevant consumer organizations or local authorities, and who is eligible to exercise their rights under laws such as Republic Act No. 7394. The inclusion criteria for the study include adults aged 18 years and above, residents of Agusan del Norte, and individuals who actively purchase goods and services from retail establishments such as supermarkets, grocery stores, and convenience stores.

Conversely, the exclusion criteria include individuals below 18 years old, non-residents of Agusan del Norte, those who do not engage in market transactions, and those who are unable or unwilling to provide informed responses. These consumers are significant to the study because they constitute the primary group responsible for exercising consumer rights. Their level of awareness and knowledge reflects the effectiveness of consumer education initiatives, legal frameworks, and information dissemination efforts. Assessing this group will provide valuable

insights into gaps in understanding and application of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights, which are essential for improving consumer protection strategies at both local and national levels.

Table 1. Population Sample Size

Respondents	Sex	Population (F)	Sample Size (f)	Percentage (%)
Buenavista	Female	30,602	106	27.6
	Male	31,745	110	28.6
Nasipit	Female	15,275	53	13.8
	Male	14,843	51	13.3
Carmen	Female	9,111	32	8.3
	Male	9,197	32	8.3
Total		110,773	384	100.0

Table 1 presents the distribution of respondents according to municipality and sex, showing both the population figures and the corresponding sample sizes. The total population across the three municipalities is 110,773, composed of 55,785 males and 54,988 females. From this population, a total of 384 respondents were selected for the study.

Buenavista contributed the largest share of respondents with 216 participants (56.3%), reflecting its relatively larger population compared to the other municipalities. Nasipit accounted for 104 respondents (27.1%), while Carmen provided 64 respondents (16.7%). The distribution of respondents by sex is nearly equal, with 193 males (50.3%) and 191 females (49.7%), indicating a balanced representation of both sexes in the sample.

Overall, the proportional allocation of respondents across municipalities and sex ensures adequate representation of the study population, thereby strengthening the reliability and generalizability of the study's findings.

2.4 Research Instrument

The study will utilize a structured survey questionnaire as its main tool for data collection, which is modified from the instrument developed by Chona Pajarillo-Agustin in her study *"Consumer Awareness Assessment Survey in the province of Cagayan."*

While the original instrument will provide the foundation, the questionnaire will be partially modified and contextualized to suit the objectives and research locale of the present study. These adjustments will ensure that the instrument will accurately capture information on consumer awareness, knowledge of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights under Republic Act No. 7394, also known as the Consumer Act of the Philippines, and DTI Policy Advisory No. 22-01. The survey instrument will be organized into three (3) parts:

Part I – Demographic Profile of the Respondents: This section will gather basic information such as age, sex, educational attainment, and customer category.

Part II – Access to Consumer Information: This section will assess respondents' level of access to consumer information, including exposure to mass media, printed information materials, and community or institutional information services.

Part III – Awareness and Knowledge of Basic Consumer Rights: This section will have two subsections:

Awareness Subsection: Respondents will rate their level of awareness of each of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights.

Knowledge Subsection (Function-Based): Respondents will indicate their level of agreement with statements reflecting the practical application of each right.

The data collected from these sections served as a comprehensive basis for analyzing the extent of consumer awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights, as well as for generating insights relevant to understanding the level of consumer protection in Agusan del Norte.

To ensure validity, the instrument will undergo content and face validation. Consumer protection experts and academic advisers will evaluate the questionnaire for clarity, relevance, and appropriateness in measuring consumer awareness and knowledge. Recommendations from this process will be incorporated to refine the survey.

Pilot testing will also be conducted with a small sample of registered consumers in Agusan del Norte who will not be included in the main study. The pilot test will help determine the reliability of the instrument, identify ambiguous or confusing items, and estimate the time required for completion. Data from the pilot study will be analyzed to calculate reliability coefficients, ensuring that the survey will consistently measure the intended variables.

The data collected from these sections will provide a comprehensive basis for analyzing the extent of consumer awareness and knowledge of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights, and will generate insights relevant to understanding consumer protection levels in Agusan del Norte.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

This study will not cover the creation of any innovative technology or product that requires patent protection. An existing research instrument will be used as a basis for modifying or adapting the survey questionnaire that will be used in this study. Permission will be required from the original creator of this instrument. Copyright laws will be used to ensure that the updated instrument is protected and appropriate in the particular situation. Since no new logo or symbol is being created, trademark registration is also not required.

B. Informed Consent

The researcher will inform the people who are taking part in the study what it is for and how it will help them through a formal orientation and a written consent form. Participants will be asked to sign the permission form to show that they agree. Participants will have the chance to ask questions and the option to decline or leave at any moment.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The researcher will keep all of the answers completely private and only use them for research. To safeguard the privacy of participants, all the information collected will be made anonymous. The data will be safely stored in a password-protected file that only the researcher and academic supervisors can access. Explicit written consent will be acquired from the respondents in case it is shared with third parties. All procedures will be fulfilled with ethical standards for research involving human participants. All research instruments and collected data will be handled responsibly throughout and after the study. Hard copies of the accomplished survey questionnaires will be stored securely in a locked storage box within the research office or designated faculty room. These documents will be kept for five (5) years in compliance with

institutional and ethical research standards. After the retention period, all hard copies will be securely shredded to ensure the complete protection of participant information.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

The participation in this study will be at the participants' free will. Every respondent will be informed of the purpose and procedures of the analysis, together with their rights to withdraw without suffering any consequences.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

The study will be conducted meticulously to prevent any physical, psychological, or emotional risk to participants. The survey will contain no sensitive information, and all participants will be fully informed about the study's purpose, procedures, and potential risks. Surveys will be distributed to participants to answer at home, giving them adequate time to respond thoughtfully. Completed surveys will be secured and collected the following day to ensure data integrity. Participants will be informed of their right to withdraw at any time without penalty. Should any participant experience distress, support services will be available. The study does not involve animal participants, so animal welfare and the 3Rs (Replacement, Reduction, Refinement) are not applicable.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

This study will have a positive impact on both the academic community and society as a whole since it will provide data-driven insights concerning consumer awareness and protection in Agusan del Norte. This conforms with the implementation of Republic Act 7394, also known as the Consumer Act of the Philippines. The results of this study will be a valuable resource for local governments, helping them make better policies, promote future academic research, and help

groups who want to increase consumer welfare. Participants will be able to get the research results if they ask for them.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

This study will select volunteers fairly and transparently. Only individuals who reside in Agusan del Norte and are registered consumers will be eligible to participate. The selection process will ensure that participants reflect the study's targeted demographic characteristics, including age, sex, educational attainment. This approach guarantees that all groups are treated equitably, providing a balanced representation of the population and enhancing the reliability and fairness of the study.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Standardized approaches will be used to ensure that both data collection and analysis are accurate and trustworthy. The survey tool will be modified based on validated sources to provide clarity and alignment with the study objectives. To make comparisons easier and reduce differences, all participating consumers will use the same methods to collect data. We will use appropriate statistical techniques to conduct quantitative analysis so that it is fair and accurate. A statistician will help the researchers ensure the data analysis is correct. To keep things honest and open, any potential biases, mistakes, or restrictions will be carefully examined and acknowledged.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The study's results will be reported honestly and openly, making sure that all interpretations of the data are based on data that was collected honestly and carefully and has not been made up or changed. All copyrighted and patented materials utilized in the research and development will be appropriately credited and recognized in compliance with ethical and academic norms.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

This study won't use any proprietary technologies, so it won't need permission from patent holders. The research will utilize copyrighted materials, encompassing published literature and survey instruments sourced from reputable academic and governmental publications. All content will be appropriately attributed and credited in accordance with intellectual property rights laws. When necessary, the proper permits will be sought to make sure that ethical standards are followed and that the original authorship is respected.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

All human participants will be fully informed of the potential risks and benefits before their involvement. A written informed consent form will be provided. Participants will be made aware of their right to withdraw at any time without penalty. This study will not involve the use of animals; therefore, ethical clearance for animal trials will not be applicable.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Other Related Technologies

The study will use AI to help with several parts of the research process. The project will employ ChatGPT and Microsoft Pilot to aid the researcher in writing, alongside Grammarly and Quillbot to improve grammatical precision. These AI techniques will help the paper by making it more efficient and helping to find patterns and trends in quantitative data. To protect the integrity of both the data and the use of AI, the researcher will carefully check and confirm that all AI-generated outputs are correct and valuable. We will be open about any work that AI makes, and we will observe strong ethical standards for data protection, authorship, and intellectual property throughout the investigation.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

Ethical approval for this study will be obtained from the institutional review board of Saint Michael College of Caraga. The committee will review the research proposal to ensure that all procedures involving human participants comply with ethical standards.

2.6 Data Gathering Procedure

With the approval and permission of the appropriate authorities, the researchers will conduct data gathering in the selected municipalities of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte. The appropriate authorities will include the Commission on Elections (COMELEC) for access to population and voter data, the Local Government Units (LGUs) of each municipality for community coordination, and the Barangay offices for local facilitation and verification of resident respondents. These institutions will provide essential documents, population data, and guidance, which will serve as supporting references for selecting respondents and ensuring the reliability of the sampling process.

The data gathering process will follow a series of organized steps to ensure systematic, ethical, and accurate collection of information:

Letter of Approval

The researchers will prepare and submit a formal letter of request to the COMELEC, the LGUs, and the Barangay offices to secure permission to conduct the study. The letter will outline the objectives, significance, and procedures of the research and will request access to relevant data for sampling and validation purposes.

Orientation

An orientation session will be conducted for both the respondents and local facilitators. During the orientation, the purpose of the study, the importance of participants' responses, and the ethical standards governing the research will be explained. This step will ensure that

participants understand their role, the voluntary nature of participation, and the confidentiality of their responses.

Distribution of Informed Consent Form

Participants will receive an informed consent form to confirm that they understand their rights and voluntarily agree to participate in the study. The form will inform respondents that they may withdraw at any time without consequences and will explain how their responses will be used solely for research purposes.

Distribution of Questionnaires

The researchers will personally administer the structured survey questionnaires to the selected respondents. Respondents will be given sufficient time and a distraction-free environment to answer the questions carefully and honestly. This step will help ensure the accuracy, reliability, and completeness of the collected data. Researchers will be available to clarify any questions regarding the survey instrument, without influencing the respondents' answers.

Retrieval of Questionnaires and Consent Forms

After the respondents have completed the survey, the researchers will collect the questionnaires and consent forms. Each questionnaire will be checked for completeness and legibility at the time of retrieval to minimize missing or inconsistent data.

Data Organization and Analysis

Once the questionnaires are collected, the data will be organized, encoded, and entered into statistical software for analysis. The descriptive-quantitative method will be employed to summarize and interpret the findings on consumers' awareness and knowledge of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights. Tables, charts, and percentages will be used to present results clearly, while

cross-tabulations will examine relationships between demographic factors, access to information, and consumer awareness.

This structured procedure will ensure that the data gathering is systematic, ethical, and aligned with the objectives of the study, providing a solid foundation for generating accurate insights into consumer awareness and knowledge in Agusan del Norte.

2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedure

The data gathered from the survey questionnaires were coded, tabulated, and analyzed using appropriate quantitative statistical techniques to address the objectives of the study. The analysis focused on describing the level of consumer awareness and knowledge of the Eight Basic Consumer Rights and examining the relationship between selected variables.

Frequency and Percentage Distribution were used to describe the demographic profile of the respondents and to summarize their responses regarding awareness and knowledge of basic consumer rights. This tool allowed the study to present how often particular responses occurred and the proportion of respondents who shared similar levels of awareness, thereby providing a clear overview of response patterns.

The Weighted Mean was utilized to determine the overall level of consumer awareness and knowledge based on respondents' answers to the survey items measured using a Likert scale. By assigning weights to each response option, the weighted mean provided a numerical representation of the respondents' collective level of agreement or awareness for each indicator, as well as an overall assessment for each consumer right.

To determine the relationship between consumer awareness and consumer knowledge of basic consumer rights, Pearson's correlation coefficient (r) was employed. This statistical tool measured the strength and direction of the linear relationship between the two variables. The

results of the correlation analysis helped establish whether a significant association exists between the level of awareness and the level of knowledge among consumers in Agusan del Norte.

Overall, the application of these statistical tools ensured a systematic and objective analysis of the data, enabling the study to draw valid conclusions based on empirical evidence.

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APPENDICES

CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTIC AUTHORSHIP